

Srishha Bista

📍 Kathmandu, Nepal

🌐 [linkedin.com/in/srishha-bista-2568a9194](https://www.linkedin.com/in/srishha-bista-2568a9194)

✉ Srishha047@gmail.com

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am interested in studying resilient and productive farming systems by exploring insect-plant interactions, insect behavior, and ecological dynamics to develop sustainable pest management strategies.

EDUCATION

Agriculture and Forestry University

M.S. Entomology (3.70 CGPA)

Chitwan, Nepal

Feb 2022- Nov 2024

Relevant Courses: Integrated pest management, Insect ecology & physiology

Completed Thesis titled “Ovipositional Preference and Management of Pulse Beetle Using Edible Oils in Chitwan, Nepal”

Agriculture and Forestry University,

Bachelors in Agriculture Science (3.50 CGPA)

Chitwan, Nepal

Dec 2016- Jan 2021

Relevant Courses: Crop protection, Entomology, Plant pathology, Agronomy

Completed Thesis titled “Assessment of knowledge, perception, and practice of pesticide use by vegetable growers in Lalitpur, Nepal”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Project Coordinator, SAHAS Nepal

March 2024 - Present

Project: Food and Nutrition Security

Responsible for managing all the activities conducted under this project leading a group of eight staffs. Coordinate activities to promote diversified and profitable and advanced agricultural practices, including training farmers on climate-resilient crops, sustainable farming techniques, and water management to marginalized groups.

- Strengthened community based organizations to ensure long-term project sustainability and independence.
- Collaboration with stakeholders, including government agencies, NGOs, and local communities, to align project goals with national food security strategies
- Research based activities in farmers field such as participatory variety selection assessing the qualities of seed, disease pest resistance and yield, System of rice intensification
- Published an information sheet of Black soldier fly and its advantage as a sustainable approach and circular economy

Research Assistant, International Development Enterprise Nepal

Dec 2022 - Nov 2023

Project: Feed the future integrated pest management

- Conducted mass production of beneficial insects, including *Trichogramma* sp. and *Telenomus* sp., for biological pest control method.
- Monitored field efficacy of released parasitoids, collecting and analyzing data to assess their impact on pest populations and crop health.
- Implemented sustainable pest management practices by collaborating with researchers and farmers, promoting the adoption of biological control methods as part of integrated pest management (IPM) strategies, which contributed to reduced pesticide use and improved crop yields.

Census Supervisor, Central Bureau of Statistics, Nepal

March 2022- May 2022

- Conducted data cleaning and validation to maintain high-quality datasets for analysis and reporting, supporting evidence based agricultural planning and policy-making.
- Received comprehensive 9-days training on data collection, cleaning, and interpretation, enhancing skills in data management and analysis specific to agriculture census data.

Intern, Prime Minister Agriculture Modernization Project

February, 2021- July, 2021

- Conducted soil surveys and sampling to assess soil health and fertility, supporting the development of tailored agricultural recommendations.
- Conducted a study on the effects of pesticides on vegetable crops, analyzing data to evaluate impacts on crop health, yield, and environmental sustainability.
- Gained hands-on experience in agricultural research, data collection, and analysis (R-studio, Stata, and SPSS) contributing to the project's goals of enhancing food security and farmer livelihoods.

PUBLICATIONS

- Srisha Bista, Manisha Kumari Thapa, Saugat Khanal, P. (2020). Fall armyworm: Menace to Nepalese farming and the integrated management approaches. *International Journal of Environment Agriculture and Biotechnology*, 5(4), 1011-1018.10.22161/ijeab.54.21

TRAINING & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Recipient of **research grant** by USAID Nepal Higher Education Project for the study “Ovipositional Preference and Management of Pulse Beetle Using Edible Oils in Chitwan, Nepal”.
- Received **seed funding** from Energize Nepal Program and Kathmandu University Business Incubation Centre for the innovative idea “**Potential Use of Black Soldier Fly as Animal Feed**”.
- Selected with **full funding** from Caritas Nepal for a five-month-long **Farmers Field School (FFS) training** on 'Integrated Pest Management Program for small farmers' earning top honors.
- Received **comprehensive 9-days training** on data collection, cleaning, and interpretation, **enhancing** skills in data management and analysis from Central Bureau of Statistics, Nepal Government.
- Presented and participated in a province-level workshop on Biological control of pests, contributing to knowledge exchange and dialogue on sustainable pest management.
- Engaged in a practical 3-day training on protected cultivation (plastic tunnel and greenhouse management), organized by PMAMP.
- Participated in a 2-day training on **Agro-ecological practices and integrated nutrient management** through a capacity-building program supported by ICIMOD and Agriculture and Forestry University.
- Participated in a one-day conference on Climate Resilient Agriculture, organized by Finn Church Aid, contributing to the finalization of a policy brief developed under the CRA initiative.
- Attended a four-day workshop on **Climate Change and Resilient Communities**, facilitated by SAHAS Nepal.
- Participated in a two-day national conference on **Locally-led Climate Adaptation: Governance and Justice**, jointly organized by Prakriti Resource Center and CARE Nepal.

SKILLS

- **Data Analysis & Interpretation**

- More than 3 years of experience in Statistical analysis with SPSS, Stata, R-Studio, and Python
- More than 3 years of experience in Kobo Toolbox for Data collection

- **Geospatial Analysis:** Skilled in ArcGIS for spatial analysis and visualization of geographic data

REFERENCES

Dr. Min Raj Pokhrel
Associate professor
Department of Entomology,
Agriculture and Forestry University
mrpokhrel@afu.edu.np

Dr. Sundar Tiwari
Professor
Department of Entomology,
Agriculture and Forestry University
stiwari@afu.edu.np

Lalit Prasad Sah
Agriculture Project Lead
International Development
Enterprise (iDE) Nepal
lpsah@ideglobal.org